

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 29, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 48:1-14

1 "Now these are the names of the tribes: From the northern border along the road to Hethlon at the entrance of Hamath, to Hazar Enan, the border of Damascus northward, in the direction of Hamath, there shall be one section for Dan from its east to its west side;

2 by the border of Dan, from the east side to the west, one section for Asher;

3 by the border of Asher, from the east side to the west, one section for Naphtali;

4 by the border of Naphtali, from the east side to the west, one section for Manasseh;

5 by the border of Manasseh, from the east side to the west, one section for Ephraim;

6 by the border of Ephraim, from the east side to the west, one section for Reuben;

7 by the border of Reuben, from the east side to the west, one section for Judah;

8 by the border of Judah, from the east side to the west, shall be the district which you shall set apart, twenty-five thousand cubits in width, and in length the same as one of the other portions, from the east side to the west, with the sanctuary in the center.

9 "The district that you shall set apart for the Lord shall be twenty-five thousand cubits in length and ten thousand in width.

10 To these—to the priests—the holy district shall belong: on the north twenty-five thousand cubits in length, on the west ten thousand in width, on the east ten thousand in width, and on the south twenty-five thousand in length. The sanctuary of the Lord shall be in the center.

11 It shall be for the priests of the sons of Zadok, who are sanctified, who have kept My charge, who did not go astray when the children of Israel went astray, as the Levites went astray.

12 And this district of land that is set apart shall be to them a thing most holy by the border of the Levites.

13 "Opposite the border of the priests, the Levites shall have an area twenty-five thousand cubits in length and ten thousand in width; its entire length shall be twenty-five thousand and its width ten thousand.

14 And they shall not sell or exchange any of it; they may not alienate this best part of the land, for it is holy to the Lord.

II. Key Summary

- God divides the land starting from the far north — Dan, Asher, Naphtali, Manasseh, Ephraim, Reuben, and Judah each receive one section, every tribe getting a full strip running from east to west (vv. 1-7).

- Next to the border of Judah, a "district" is to be set apart for the Lord, twenty-five thousand cubits wide and the same length as the other portions, with the sanctuary located in its center (vv. 8-10).

- This holy district belongs to the priests of the sons of Zadok, who the text says did not go astray when the children of Israel went astray; the Levites' land beside it may not be sold or exchanged, because it is holy to the Lord (vv. 11-14).

III. Passage Analysis

The Sanctuary Placed at the Center

The center of the land of Israel is the holy district, and God's sanctuary is located at the center of that district — showing that the Israel to come is a spiritual community centered on God. [1]

This long stretch of measurements looks like dry surveying data, but the arrangement itself is the message: God did not put the sanctuary in a corner or along the edge. He put it dead center. He isn't asking for a slot in your life — He's asking for the middle one.

Holding On When Everyone Else Drifts

Ministers faithful to the Lord in the worst of times; and who are and will be taken notice of by him, both now and hereafter. [2]

Verse 11 singles out the sons of Zadok because they "did not go astray... as the Levites went astray" — when the people around them drifted one by one, they kept what God had charged them to keep. The point is that God remembers who stood firm in that moment, and He answers that faithfulness with the place closest to Himself.

IV. Reflection Question

List out what you actually spent the most time on and thought about most this week — which one sits right in the middle?

In the land Ezekiel saw, the sanctuary stood at the exact center — God has never been asking for a slot in your life, but for the middle one.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (ccbiblestudy.org), Bible Intensive Reading Commentary, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT48.htm>

[2] BibleHub.com, Gill's Exposition of the Entire Bible, <https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/48-11.htm>